

Knock on the right door.

How Knock looks, sounds and behaves. A private career service for MBA and product candidates in India, written like a letter, not a product launch.



AIRMAIL LETTER CONCEPT POWDER BLUE NAVY ONE RED STAMP

Brand story and positioning

Most people apply through portals and wait. Knock does the slower, more human thing: it finds the right people at a candidate's target companies, learns about each one, and writes to them as one person to another.

What Knock is

A premium, human, tech-enabled service. Think of a private career concierge. We find hiring managers, team members, alumni and senior connectors at the companies a candidate wants to join, research each one, find a genuine shared reason to talk, write a personal first message and guide every reply. The candidate approves every message.

FOR	MBA graduates and people moving into product management in India.
PROMISE	Interviews through the people who work at your target companies.
QUALITY	Sixty hand-picked people a week, not thousands.
MEASURE	Interviews per 100 targeted prospects.
TAGLINE	Knock on the right door.

Service first

Knock is a service delivered by people. Technology is how we deliver it, never the headline. The words for it are concierge, researched, by hand.

Quality over volume

A short list of the right people beats a long list of anyone. We would rather send fewer messages that each deserve a reply.

The candidate stays in charge

Every message is approved before it is sent. Nothing goes out in a candidate's name without their yes.

Honest about results

We do not pad lists, promise outcomes, or quote numbers we have not measured. Specific beats impressive.

The letter metaphor

Every Knock touchpoint is a piece of mail that arrived on purpose. Powder-blue airmail paper, navy ink, one red stamp, a postmark that says where it came from. The metaphor is the reason for each design choice and the test for new ones: would this belong on a good letter?

Voice and tone

Knock sounds like a thoughtful person who has read about you and has something specific to say. Calm, specific, human.

Calm

No urgency tricks, no hype. Short sentences. We never shout, and we never promise what we cannot control.

Specific

Name the company, the role, the shared school. A concrete detail replaces an adjective every time.

Human

Write as one person to another. Use "we" and "you". Say "write", not "generate". Say "person", not "lead".

Hard rules

- No em dashes. Use a full stop, a comma or a colon.
- No exclamation marks, anywhere.
- Sentence case for headlines. Full stops are fine on headlines.
- No invented testimonials, statistics or logos. If we have not measured it, we do not say it.
- AI is never the headline. If it must be mentioned, it comes late and plainly.
- Prices are in rupees and shown upfront.

Words we do not use

- AI-powered
- revolutionary
- guaranteed
- game-changing
- cutting-edge
- supercharge
- hack
- unlock
- 10x
- blast
- leads
- automation

"Guaranteed" is banned because we do not guarantee outcomes. If a reply promise exists, it states exactly what we will do and what we will not.

Say it like this

NOT THIS

Our revolutionary AI-powered platform guarantees interviews!

THIS

We find the people who hire for your target roles, and write to each one by hand.

NOT THIS

Unlock 10x more leads with automated outreach.

THIS

Sixty carefully chosen people a week. You approve every message.

NOT THIS

Apply smarter. Land your dream job faster!

THIS

Stop applying. Start conversations.

NOT THIS

Our AI crafts hyper-personalised messages at scale.

THIS

Each message starts from something you genuinely share with the person reading it.

Tone by moment

MOMENT	TONE	EXAMPLE
Website and ads	Plain, confident, slightly wry	<i>Job portals are a queue. People hire people.</i>
First client email	Warm, organised	<i>Here is what happens in the next seven days, and what we need from you today.</i>
A message needs approval	Brief, respectful	<i>Your draft to the product manager at Zepto is ready. Read it, change anything, then approve.</i>
Slow results	Honest, practical	<i>Two replies so far. Here is what we are changing for next week.</i>

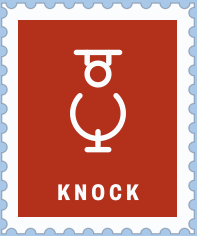
Logo

The mark is a postage stamp carrying a door knocker. The wordmark pairs the stamp with Knock set in Archivo Extra Condensed ExtraBold. Text in the logo files is converted to outlines, so no font is needed to use them.



Knock

Use the wordmark for headers, signatures and documents. Use the stamp on its own for avatars, social marks and as the one red element in a layout.



STAMP ON BLUE



Knock

REVERSED WORDMARK



ONE COLOUR STAMP



FAVICON, AVATAR

Clearspace

Keep a margin of x on every side, where x is a quarter of the stamp's width. Nothing enters the dashed area: not text, not another logo, not the edge of the page.



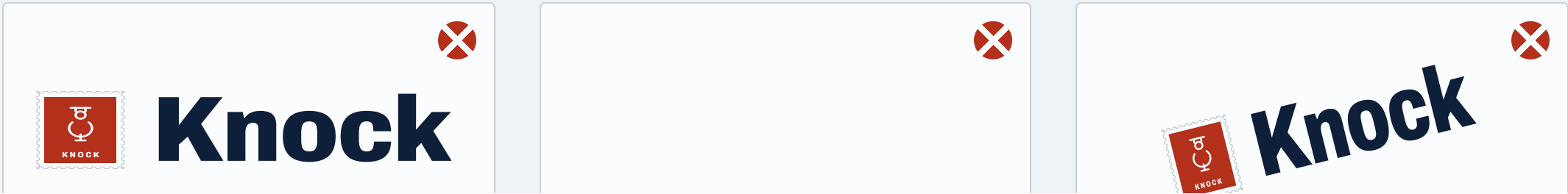
Minimum size

STAMP	24px wide on screen, 10mm in print. Below that, use the favicon.
WORDMARK	90px wide on screen, 25mm in print.
FAVICON	16px and up. The knocker is drawn heavier so it holds at small sizes.
TILT	The stamp may sit at 3 degrees, as on a real letter. The wordmark never tilts.

Files

SVG masters and 512px and 1024px PNG exports are in the logo folder: knock-wordmark, knock-stamp, knock-stamp-mono, knock-favicon.

Misuse





Do not stretch or squash.



Do not recolour the stamp. It is always postal red.



Do not tilt the wordmark.



No glows, bevels or hard shadows.



Do not place the logo on a colour that hides it.



Do not retype the name in another typeface.

Colour

Powder-blue paper, navy ink, one postal red. The blues carry the page. Red is a stamp, not a theme, so it appears once per layout.

Inland

#A9C7E6

RGB 169, 199, 230

--knock-inland

The airmail paper. Hero sheets, banners, social cards.

Inland light

#C4D9EF

RGB 196, 217, 239

--knock-inland-3

Ledgers and secondary panels on blue.

Paper

#EEF3F8

RGB 238, 243, 248

--knock-paper

Page background.

White

#FAFCFE

RGB 250, 252, 254

--knock-white

Cards, notes, stamp border.

Navyink

#0E1F3A

RGB 14, 31, 58

--knock-ink

Headlines, body, dark surfaces.

Ink2

#2B4266

RGB 43, 66, 102

--knock-ink-2

Supporting text.

Ink3

#4A5F80

RGB 74, 95, 128

--knock-ink-3

Captions on paper or white only.

Postal red

#B3301B

RGB 179, 48, 27

--knock-post

The stamp. One per layout.



Rough proportions for a typical layout. Red above about five per cent stops being a stamp. Highlighter wash #F3D9D2 sits behind one key phrase at most.

Contrast ratios

Computed with the WCAG 2.1 relative luminance formula. Body text needs 4.5:1 for AA and 7:1 for AAA. Large text (24px, or 19px bold) needs 3:1.

SWATCH	USE	PAIR	RATIO	RESULT
Aa	Body text on page	#0E1F3A on #EEF3F8	14.74:1	AAA
Aa	Text on cards	#0E1F3A on #FAFCFE	16.01:1	AAA
Aa	Text on the sheet	#0E1F3A on #A9C7E6	9.41:1	AAA
Aa	Text on ledger panels	#0E1F3A on #C4D9EF	11.38:1	AAA
Aa	Secondary text on page	#2B4266 on #EEF3F8	9.07:1	AAA
Aa	Secondary text on the sheet	#2B4266 on #A9C7E6	5.79:1	AA
Aa	Captions on page	#4A5F80 on #EEF3F8	5.81:1	AA
Aa	Captions on cards	#4A5F80 on #FAFCFE	6.30:1	AA
Aa	Captions on the sheet (avoid)	#4A5F80 on #A9C7E6	3.70:1	AA large
Aa	Reversed text on navy	#FAFCFE on #0E1F3A	16.01:1	AAA
Aa	Reversed text on navy	#EEF3F8 on #0E1F3A	14.74:1	AAA

SWATCH	USE	PAIR	RATIO	RESULT
Aa	Accent text on navy	#A9C7E6 on #0E1F3A	9.41:1	AAA
Aa	White on postal red	#FAFCFE on #B3301B	6.09:1	AA
Aa	Red text on page	#B3301B on #EEF3F8	5.61:1	AA
Aa	Red text on cards	#B3301B on #FAFCFE	6.09:1	AA
Aa	Red text on the sheet (avoid)	#B3301B on #A9C7E6	3.58:1	AA large
Aa	Text on highlighter wash	#0E1F3A on #F3D9D2	12.28:1	AAA
Aa	Red on navy (avoid)	#B3301B on #0E1F3A	2.63:1	Fail
Aa	Dark-mode red on dark bg	#E8705A on #0A1628	5.95:1	AA
Aa	Muted text on navy	#BFD0E6 on #0E1F3A	10.49:1	AAA

What this means

- Navy on any blue or paper passes AAA. This is the default for text.
- Ink 3 on the powder-blue sheet is 3.7:1. Use Ink 2 there, or keep Ink 3 for white and paper.
- Red text on powder blue is 3.6:1. Use it for large display only, never for body or small labels.
- Red on navy fails. In dark mode use the lighter red, 5.95:1.

Tokens

All values live in `tokens.css` and `tokens.json`: colour, type scale, spacing, radii and shadows, with light and dark roles. Dark mode switches on `prefers-color-scheme` or `data-theme="dark"`.

DARK VARIANT

Same letter, night shift.

Navy becomes the page. Powder blue becomes the accent. The stamp red lightens so it stays legible.

Get my target list

bg #0A1628

surface #0E1F3A

surface 2 #16294A

text #EEF3F8

text2 #BFD0E6

accent #A9C7E6

red #E8705A

A card on the dark surface, with body text in paper and the muted line in a lighter blue.

Muted caption text, 8.5:1 and above.

Accent red for a single mark

Typography

A condensed grotesque for headlines and a serif for the words people read. Both are free from Google Fonts.

Stop applying.
Start
conversations.

5xl 96
Knock

3xl 58
The right door

xl 28
Researched one at a time

lg 21
We write to each person by hand.

md 18
Interface and document body text.

xs 12
FOLD HERE

Archivo, width 72, weight 800

Headlines, numerals, stamp lettering. Tight tracking (-0.015em), line height 0.95, sentence case. Fallback: Arial Narrow.

Archivo, width 100

UI text, labels and buttons. Small caps labels are uppercase, 600 weight, 0.12em tracking.

Source Serif 4

Body copy in letters and ledes, the address line and quotations. Italic for "To", quotes and the shared reason to talk. Fallback: Georgia.

Scale and rules

- Ten steps from 12px to 96px: xs, sm, base, md, lg, xl, 2xl, 3xl, 4xl, 5xl. Hero headlines use 5xl at most.
- Body line length 45 to 62 characters. Body line height 1.55.
- Never set body copy in the display face.
- Headlines may carry a full stop. They never end in an exclamation mark.
- Numerals in prices use the display face, for example Rs 2,499.

Motifs

Four pieces of postal furniture give Knock its character. Each one has a job. Use one or two per layout, never all four.



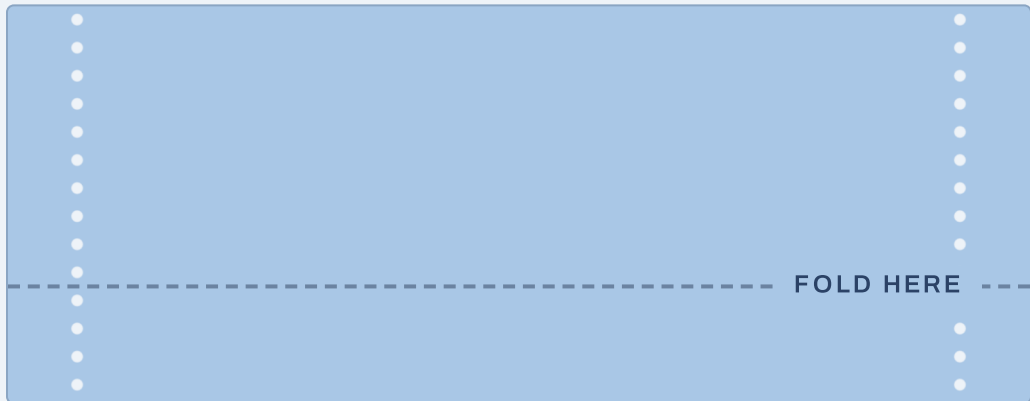
Stamp

The one red element. It marks the sender and the main action. Top right, tilted 3 degrees, one per layout. Never repeat it as a pattern.



Postmark

Carries the tagline in a ring: Knock on the right door. Navy at 72 per cent, multiplied over the paper, overlapping the stamp's corner, tilted -14 degrees. It says where the letter came from. Do not set it over body text.



Perforation and fold

Dotted edges on the sheet and a dashed fold line where one zone gives way to the next. Use them to separate, never to decorate. Edges only on the largest surface in the layout.



Address line

An italic serif "To" and a navy rule. This is where the working action lives: a field, a name, a list of companies. It is the friendliest form of a call to action.

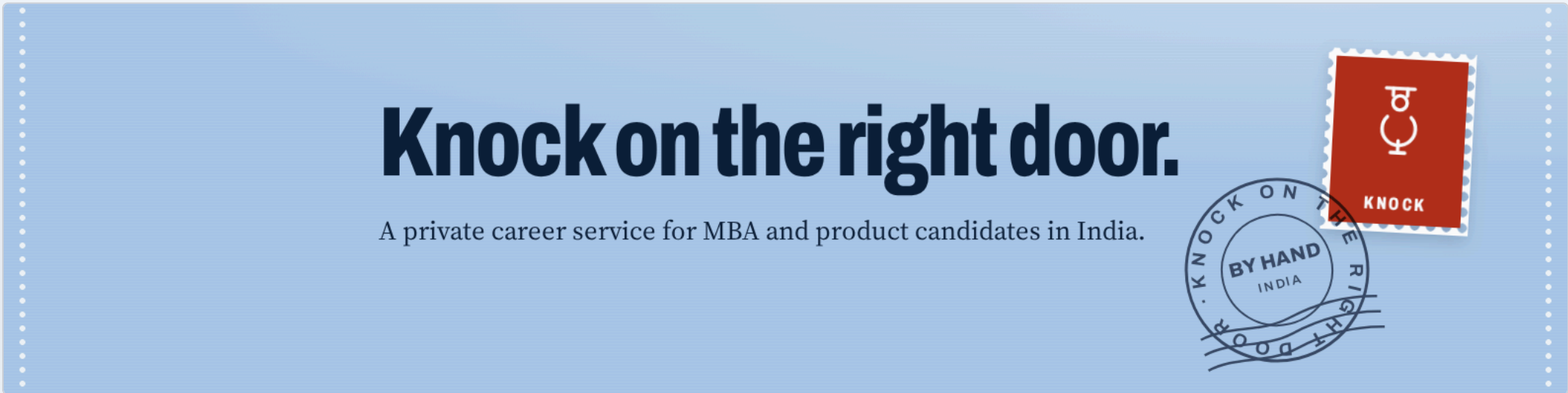
Restraint

- Count the red. One stamp, plus red only for focus and a single key mark.
- If a layout has a stamp and a postmark, drop the perforation, or the reverse.
- Motifs sit at the edges. The middle of the page belongs to the words.
- On dark surfaces, remove the postmark and keep the stamp.

Example applications

Source files for all of these are in the templates folder. Names and rows are placeholders or labelled samples. Nothing here is a real client, quote or result.

LinkedIn banner, 1584 x 396



Keep the left 340px clear: the profile photo covers it on desktop.

templates/linkedin-banner.html and .png

LinkedIn post card, 1200 x 1200



templates/linkedin-post.html and .png

Anatomy

- One headline, two lines, display face.
- A serif line of explanation. Under 25 words.
- A sample ledger band, labelled as a sample, below a dashed fold.
- The address line closes the card.

Social preview, 1200 x 630



templates/og-image.png

Email signature



Knock

[Your name]

[Role], Knock

[you@knock.careers]

[knock.careers](#)

Knock on the right door.

templates/email-signature.html. Email-safe: tables, Georgia and Arial, one hosted image.

Deck title slide

KNOCK · INTRODUCTION



Knock on the right door.

A private career service for MBA and product candidates in India.

Navy slide, one stamp, a dashed fold. No postmark on dark.

Operator CRM header



Knock

Clients

Prospects

Messages

Replies

Operator

Client

[Client name]

Sample layout. Placeholder data only.

Hiring manager, Product	[Company]	[The shared reason to talk]	● Message drafted
Product manager, Growth	[Company]	[The shared reason to talk]	● Researching

Navy bar with the reversed wordmark, a red underline for the current tab, and a blue ledger header under a dashed fold.

Photography and illustration

Real people, real places, real paper. The imagery should feel like a private correspondence, never like a software dashboard.

Photography

- People at work in India: a desk, a notebook, a phone mid-message, a hand with a pen.
- Doors, thresholds, corridors, letters, envelopes and stamps. The knock is a literal image we can use.
- Natural window light. Slightly cool, with the blues pushed toward powder blue and navy.
- Only real clients and team members, with written consent. No invented faces presented as clients.
- For hero use, a duotone of navy and powder blue keeps photos inside the palette.

Illustration

- Line drawings with a 3px round-capped stroke, like the knocker on the stamp.
- Flat fills in navy, powder blue and a single red. No gradients, no 3D.
- Subjects: envelopes, doors, keys, stamps, route lines drawn as dashed paths.
- Diagrams are drawn as routes and ledgers, not network graphs.

Never

- Robots
- Glowing brains
- Circuit boards
- Handshake stock photos
- Rocket ships
- Chat bubble clouds

Drawn in the house style



A knocker, an envelope, a route with one red destination.

Do and don't

A short set of side by side checks. If a layout fails any of the right-hand examples, rework it.

DO



A headline that states what we do, calm and specific.

DON'T



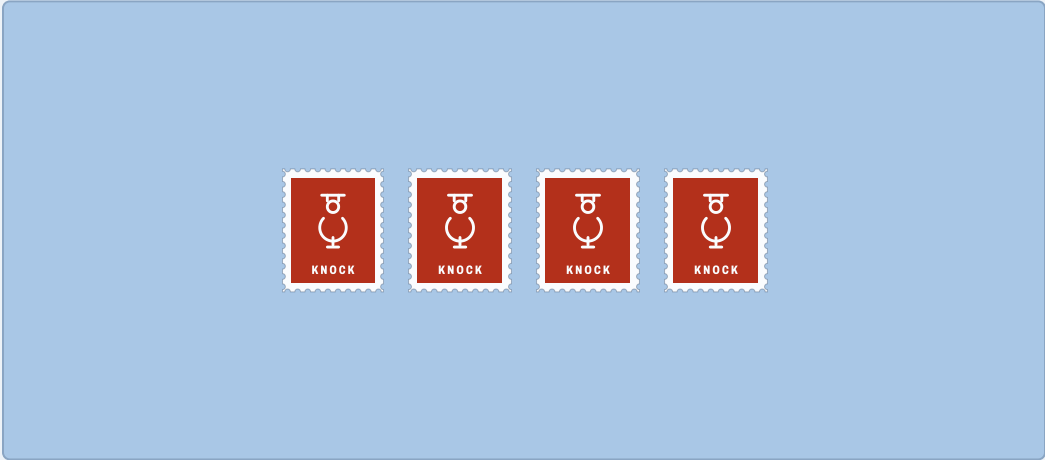
Hype words, gradients, an exclamation mark and a promise we cannot keep.

DO



One stamp. It is the sender and it is rare.

DON'T



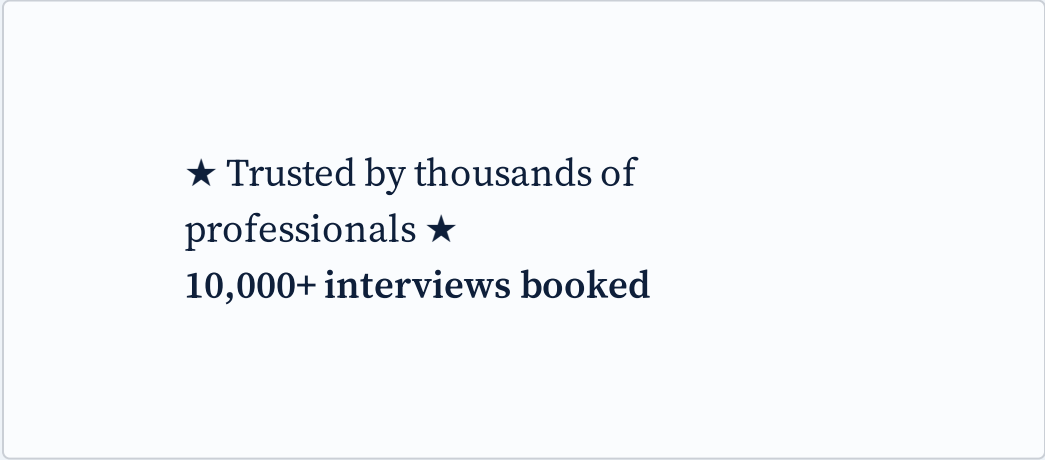
The stamp as a pattern. It stops meaning anything.

DO



A real reason, in plain sentences.

DON'T



Invented stats and star ratings. We publish only what we have measured.

DO



Reversed art on dark.

DON'T



The navy wordmark on navy.

Knock

Knock on the right door.

Brand guidelines v1.0. Derived from the winning site concept in site-competition/entry-9. Files: logo, tokens.css, tokens.json, templates.

Knock